

STEPPING STONE INTEGRATED PRESCHOOL
4448 OAKS ROAD
BRECKSVILLE, OH 44141
2021-22 SCHOOL YEAR



STAFF

Principal	Lisa Mollica	mollical@bbhcsd.org	440-740-4010
Director of Pupil Services	Cyndi Tomassetti	tomassettic@bbhcsd.org	440-740-4017
Administrative Assistant	Linda Schultz	schultzl@bbhcsd.org	440-740-4900
Teachers	Mary Duke	dukem@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1123
	Allison Evans	evansa@bbhcsd.org	440-740-1122
	Ann Marie Ashley	ashleya@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1126
	Blair Wood	kaminskib@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1122
	Jen Wible	wiblej@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1127
School Psychologist	Danielle Westbrook	westbrookd@bbhcsd.org	440-740-4903
Speech Pathologist	Sarah Amick	amicks@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1128
	Sarah Potts	pottss@bbhcsd.org	440-740- 1129
Special Educational Assistants	Louann Goodin, Susan Graziano, Lori Pasek, Joy Pfeiffer, Kathy Sayage		
Educational Assistant	Jennifer Kunka		
Physical Therapist	Sendero Therapies		
Occupational Therapist	Sendero Therapies		
Occupational Therapist Assistant	Sendero Therapies		
Audiologist	Ruth Clark		
Health aide	Holly Wheeler		
Preschool Begins:	August 25, 2021		
Preschool Ends:	May 26, 2022		
Starting/Dismissal Times:	Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday A.M. - 8:20 am – 10:50 am P.M. - 11:50 – 2:20 pm		
Picture Day:	September 2, 2021		

STEPPING STONE INTEGRATED PHILOSOPHY

We integrate a variety of methods and philosophies to maximize a student's potential by working on his/her weaknesses and building on his/her strengths. As we work within our educational setting, we want to ensure, to the greatest extent possible, the student's ability to succeed in the classroom setting.

Our related services in the preschool setting work collaboratively with the classroom teachers. This collaborative effort allows for student introduction, practice and carry-over into the classroom for the skills that are helpful to succeed in the classroom setting

FINAL FORMS

The district uses an on-line program called Final Forms to assemble information regarding your student(s). The system will retain the information as it is entered initially and only changes need to be entered, as needed, as time progresses.

STATUS CHANGES

Please update Final Forms if you have any of the following changes:

- Home phone number(s)/Cell Phone number(s)
- Home address
- Emergency contact's name, number (including area code)
- Work phone number, either or both parents and area code(s)
- Marital status
- Custody of children
- E-mail address

WITHDRAW PROCEDURES

Anyone planning to move should notify the office as soon as his or her plans are definite. The student's new address and the name and address of the new school are needed. School records of the child will be mailed to the receiving school upon the written request of the parents or the new school.

FEES

Supplies - \$30.00

Peer Model Students- supply fee is included in \$375 quarterly payments

ATTENDANCE

Regular daily class attendance and punctuality are necessary to the learning process. Parents should report any absences, late arrivals, and early dismissals to Linda Schultz in the main office. Please call 440-740-4900 or email schultz@bbhcsd.org. A message can be left 24 hours a day.

A NOTE TO THE TEACHER CAN BE SENT IN YOUR CHILD'S FOLDER FOR A PLANNED ABSENCE OR VACATION.

ARRIVAL/DISMISSAL

- Late arrivals and early dismissals must report to the Stepping Stone Main Office to sign in/out your child.
- Parents dropping off the child will form a line at the entrance of the building. Staff will be available to take students to their appropriate classrooms.
- Please be prompt when picking up your child at dismissal.
- Parents picking up students will line up at the preschool main door at dismissal time. Students will be brought to their parents. If you are a parent of a bus rider and need to pick up your child please call the main office and let Mrs. Schultz know. You will also need to park and come into the main office and sign your child out.
- DO NOT enter the building at pick-up/drop-off. It is a very busy time with students coming and going.

TRANSPORTATION

- Phone number (440) 740-4050
- Please be ready at pick-up/drop-off times (buses are on a tight schedule).
- CALL TRANSPORTATION IF YOUR CHILD WILL NOT BE RIDING THE BUS FOR THE DAY.
- All parents are required to complete a new transportation form at the beginning of each school year and whenever a change occurs with your child's transportation needs (i.e. daycare, sitters, and address change).
- Let the bus driver know if you're picking up your child from a class party.

DRESS REQUIREMENTS

Proper dress and grooming are extremely important in fostering a positive school environment. No uniform dress is required in the elementary schools. However, items of apparel, accessories, or appearance that could jeopardize the health and/or safety of the individual or cause a disruptive influence are not to be worn.

"Appropriate" shorts are defined as dress, Bermuda, athletic, or walking shorts. Students are not cut-offs, torn, or short shorts. Halter tops, tank tops, and bare midriff shirts are not permitted. Shirts with questionable statements or slogans printed on them will not be permitted. Sport sandals, aquatic sandals or heels are not appropriate for school. Closed-toed shoes are safer both for the classroom and outdoor activities.

Any student who is dressed inappropriately will be referred to the administration. Final decisions concerning standards of grooming will rest with the administration.

CURRICULA

Includes, but are not limited to: Handwriting Without Tears, The Houghton-Mifflin preschool curriculum has been adopted by the Board of Education.

TRANSITIONS

At least three months before your child's third birthday, your service coordinator will call one or more transition conferences to discuss your child's needs and preschool options. This conference could be combined with a regularly scheduled IFSP meeting. You, your service coordinator, and other members of the IFSP team as appropriate will be included. Others may be invited as well. These people may include early childhood special education staff, representatives from community programs or services (such as a child-care provider, private preschool, or Head Start), and anyone else you would like to have there, such as grandparents, neighbors, or friends who know your child well.

Together, you and the team will address a variety of topics, such as the need for an evaluation to determine eligibility; goals, timelines, and team members' responsibilities; your hopes, dreams, and concerns about your child; services and programs available; and your special education legal rights. Based on those discussions, you'll develop a transition plan and prepare for the change in programs when your child turns 3.

In order to ensure that your child's preschool experience is a positive one, the program utilizes meaningful transition activities designed to help your child transition into, within and out of the program. These activities may include the following (but not limited to)

- Parent orientation
- Student phase-in days
- Collection of background data from parents
- Annual developmental screenings
- Classroom visits to all classrooms in our preschool program
- Collaborative activities for all preschoolers to engaged with all staff and students within preschool
- Social stories to assist with transitions
- Individualized transition plans meetings for all students with special needs (peer models if request)
- Summer age appropriate activity handouts to enhance language, social and motor skills to encourage year round learning
- Kindergarten readiness information
- Kindergarten orientation
- Kindergarten school/class visit for all students going to kindergarten
- "Promotion" ceremony and party

FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

Parents are their child's first teacher, as such we invite parent involvement throughout the school year each year. The district encourages parents involvement in the following ways:

- Beginning of the year meetings/visitation
- Parent teacher conferences – two conferences during the school year
- Classroom helper
- Room parent
- Share your special skills or interests
- Storybook parent program
- Home-School activity packets
- PSO

Resources available to parents to discuss student growth and development through referrals to Red Oak. Red Oak Behavioral Health is a non-profit mental health agency serving the greater Akron community since 1963. We are advocates for children, youth, families and older adults, continually exploring innovative ways of providing professional therapeutic and community support services. The Brecksville Broadview Heights School District has a growing relationship with Red Oak Behavioral Health to provide needed services to all families within the district.

BIRTHDAYS

If you would like to arrange something special for your child's birthday, please make arrangements with the classroom teacher.

REST TIME

Students in the all-day program are given a 30 minute rest/nap opportunity each day.

SCHOOL HEALTH

Ohio law requires that preschool students have the following documents on file

1. **Annual Physical Examination:** Provided to the school within 30 days of admission into the program.

Exam performed within the past 13 months.

The date of the exam must be on the form

Include: height, weight, and dental status and referrals made

Tuberculosis Assessment: Risk Survey Results or TB skin test results

Lab/Blood Work: Blood lead and hemoglobin values if ordered by the provider

2. **Immunizations**

Immunization record provided to the school prior to attendance/admission

Must be up-to-date for their age

3. **Emergency Medical Form**

4. **Oral Assessment**

If your child's physician does not do a dental screening or refers your child to a dentist, please have the dentist complete the Oral Assessment form.

5. Eye Specialist Evaluation

Students qualifying for preschool services due to special needs are required to have an evaluation by a vision professional (ORC 3323.19)

This is a one-time evaluation, unless follow-up treatment is recommended.

Provide an eye exam form if complete within 6 months of admission.

If you do not have health insurance coverage or need assistance in any way to obtain the services for the requirements listed above, please contact the School Nurse for assistance. Lisa Witzke, BSN, RN 440-740-4706.

ILLNESS/FEVERS

A child who complains of nausea, headaches or poor health will have his/her temperature taken in the clinic. If the child has a temperature of **100 degrees** or higher, the parent will be called to take the child home. If there is not an apparent temperature, the child will rest in the clinic for a while to see if his/her condition improves. If it does not, the parent will be called to take the child home. Students sent home with fevers must be **"fever free" for 24 hours** before returning to school. Students who are vomiting or those with diarrhea must also stay home for at least 24 hours for the health and protection of all students and staff.

INJURIES

Minor injuries, such as skinned knees, will be treated in the clinic, but anything requiring treatment other than first aid is not permitted to be administered by school personnel. Parents will be notified when there is doubt about the seriousness of an injury or when injuries are considered more than minor.

HEAD/FACE INJURY PROTOCOL

- If a student receives ANY bump etc. to the head or face area he/she/needs to come to the clinic to be assessed, no matter how small.
- If NO signs/symptoms of concussion are present (dizziness/general headache/nausea/confusion/incoordination/dilated pupils etc.), students may have ice and return to class.
- If there ARE signs/symptoms of concussion present (dizziness/general headache/nausea/confusion/incoordination/dilated pupils etc.), keep the student at least 15 minutes with ice. If concerns/symptoms do not go away, ask parents to take the student to see a primary care doctor (does not necessarily need to go to the emergency room).
- Always call the parents and let them know what happened (make an effort to actually talk to someone) or at the very least leave a voicemail.
- Send with the student back to class:
- Note to the teacher regarding the head injury including the time the student left the clinic and time to come back to be re-checked in one hour.
- Head injury packet to go home (inside black binder)

If there is concern or a student needs to go see a doctor, notify the nursing supervisor at the high school and fill out an accident report and leave it on the principal's desk. Always be sure not to name other students involved if you need to include them in the report.

BLOOD BORNE PATHOGENS

Our school follows the Occupational Safety and Health Administration regulation 20 CFR 1919.1030: Occupational Exposure to Blood Borne Pathogens. The following precautions will be followed, as the state guidelines expect, for students and staff. When coming into contact with a situation that involves bleeding (bloody nose, cuts, loose teeth, etc.), we will be using gloves, which are provided for all staff. Any tooth that has fallen out will be sent home in a plastic bag with a similar label on it. You may be asked to bring in fresh clothing for your child.

MEDICATIONS TAKEN AT SCHOOL

All medications should be given to students at home when possible. Medications ordered three times a day should be given before school, after school, and bedtime. If it is necessary for a student to take medication during the school day, the following requirements **must be met** to insure our students' safety:

- Any medication must come to school in its original container with the child's name on it. Pharmacies may be asked to divide prescriptions into two bottles.
- Parents are to bring medications to the school office. Students may not carry medication on the bus.
- Complete written instructions must be given to the principal or his/her designee with the parent's written permission and signature. Forms are available in the office/clinic or on line at www.bbhcsc.org/health. There are separate forms for prescription and non-prescription medications. There are also forms for epipens and inhalers, which the students may carry with them once the forms are completed and on file in the clinic. Prescription forms should be taken to your child's physician and returned with the medication.
- Prescription medication must be accompanied by the physician's instructions, side effects that should be reported, along with their signature and phone number.
- The first dose of a new medication must not be administered at school in case of an allergic reaction.
- New requests for medication must be submitted at the beginning of each new school year or as medical needs arise. Both the physician and parent must complete new forms unless it is for non-prescription medications.

Parents must pick up unused medication. Medications will be disposed of 30 days after they are discontinued. These practices ensure that medication is given safely at school. Please call the office if you have any questions.

What is Healthchek?

Healthchek is Ohio's Early and Periodic Screening, Diagnosis and Treatment (EPSDT) Program. This program provides a core of health services to children enrolled in Healthy Start or Medicaid. The purpose of Healthchek is to discover and treat health problems early. If a potential health problem is found, further diagnosis and treatment are covered.

Who is Healthchek for?

- Children and Teens younger than 21

What does it provide?

- Prevention
- Diagnosis
- Treatment

To discover health problems, Healthchek covers Ten Check-Ups in the first two years of life and annual check-ups thereafter. Healthchek offers a comprehensive physical examination that includes:

- Medical history
- Complete unclothed examination (with parental approval)
- Developmental screening (to assess if child's physical and mental abilities are age appropriate)
- Vision screening
- Dental screening
- Hearing assessment
- Immunization assessment (making sure child receives them on time)
- Lead screening
- Other services or screenings as needed

Further information regarding free or affordable healthcare for children is available at:

<http://healthystart.cuyahogacounty.us/en-US/what-healthchek.aspx>

Immunizations

Immunization records must be provided to school within fourteen school days after the student's school start date.

Vision and hearing

Vision and hearing screening is done yearly for all preschoolers. Parents will be notified if any follow up is necessary.

Physicals

State law mandates all preschoolers have a doctor's physical form on file. It is good for 1 year from the date of examination. The State has mandated new requirements for all preschoolers (Hematocrit, Lead Levels & Dental Screenings)

MANAGEMENT OF COMMUNICABLE DISEASE

The following precautions shall be taken for children suspected of having a communicable disease:

1. The program shall notify the parent or guardian of the child's condition immediately when a child has been observed with signs or symptoms of illness.

2. A child with any of the following signs or symptoms of illness shall be isolated immediately and discharged to his parent or guardian.
 - a. Diarrhea (more than one abnormally loose stool within a 24-hour period);
 - b. Severe coughing, causing the child to become red or blue in the face or to make a whooping sound;
 - c. Difficult or rapid breathing;
 - d. Yellowish skin or eyes;
 - e. Conjunctivitis;
 - f. Temperature of 100 degrees Fahrenheit, taken by the auxiliary method, when in combination with other signs of illness;
 - g. Untreated infected skin patch(es);
 - h. Unusually dark urine and /or grey or white stool;
 - i. Stiff neck; or
 - j. Evidence of lice, scabies or other parasitic infestation.
3. A child with any of the following signs or symptoms of illness shall be isolated immediately from other children. Decisions regarding whether the child should be discharged immediately or at some other time during the day shall be determined by the director and the parent or guardian.

The child, while isolated at the program, shall be watched carefully for symptoms listed in paragraph (B) (2) of this rule as well as the following:

- a. Unusual spots or rashes;
 - b. Sore throat or difficulty in swallowing;
 - c. Elevated temperature; or
 - d. Vomiting.
4. A child isolated due to suspected communicable disease shall be:
 - a. Cared for in a room or portion of a room not being used in the preschool program;
 - b. Within sight and hearing of an adult at all times. No child shall ever be left alone or unsupervised;
 - c. Made comfortable and provided with a cot. All linens and blankets used by the ill child shall be laundered before being used by another child. After use, the cots shall be disinfected with an appropriate germicidal agent or, if soiled with blood, feces, vomit or other body fluids, the cots shall be cleaned with soap and water and then disinfected with appropriate germicidal agent;
 - d. Observed carefully for worsening condition; and
 - e. Discharged to parent, guardian or person designated by the parent or guardian as soon as practical.

SNOW/SEVERE WEATHER POLICY

Should inclement weather or other emergency situations close Brecksville-Broadview Hts. City Schools; the preschool will also be closed.

SAFETY AND SECURITY

SAFETY DRILLS

Fire drills, severe weather, and lock down, and evacuation drills are held regularly for your child's safety. Every effort will be made to teach your child calm responses throughout the drills.

EMERGENCY CLOSING OF SCHOOL

The **ALERT NOW** system will be used to contact all families for emergencies. Also, announcements will be made on local television and radio stations and will be posted on the district's website. Contacts will be made as soon as a decision has been made to cancel school.

EMERGENCY DRILLS

The school practices monthly fire drills. Each class has a specific exit point and receives instruction for this emergency exit procedure. Emergency drills for tornadoes also take place, generally in the spring. Each class is assigned a designated safe area within the building. Periodically, lockdown drills and evacuation drills are practiced as well. All drill procedures are posted in classrooms and reviewed with staff and students.

LOCK DOWN

It is hoped that school buildings in the district will never need to "lock down." However, if they do, plans have been developed to do so. A "lock down" in our schools is a response to an emergency situation dictated by local, regional, or federal authorities whereby no one, including students, staff or parents, will be permitted to enter or exit the school until the emergency "lock down" is cancelled by authorities. In such an emergency, the patience and calmness of all adults will be necessary for the successful handling of the emergency and the well being of all students.

SHELTER-IN-PLACE

Our shelter-in-place procedure is an emergency response to protect students and staff members from an outdoor hazardous environment. It will be used when needed to keep children safe until their parents can safely reach them at school. EVACUATION procedures for student release will be the same as described below for the School Evacuation Plan except that the students will remain at school. Parents are to come to school as quickly as possible, have a photo-ID, "buzz in" at the front door, and follow staff directions from there.

SCHOOL EVACUATION PLAN

Stepping Stone Preschool's Safety and Security Committee has developed an evacuation plan for our school in the event that such an exercise would be necessary. Our children would have two proposed routes to evacuate along depending on the circumstances. One route would take them where school buses would pick them up for transport home. The other area is an indoor site for our evacuation. The personnel in charge during such an evacuation have access to a telephone whereby appropriate authorities could be called and parents notified.

ASBESTOS MANAGEMENT PLAN

The asbestos-containing materials plan for each school, as well as the district, is available for public inspection and review during normal business hours at the Board of Education office. Should you have any questions concerning the management plan, please contact the school district's Asbestos Program Coordinator. This individual is the Director of Business Services and can be reached at 440-740-4016.

BEHAVIOR & GUIDANCE MANAGEMENT **STUDENT CONDUCT**

- Zero tolerance policy. No guns, weapons (even as a part of a Halloween costume).

CLASSROOM DISCIPLINE PROCEDURES

When a student does not follow directions in class, the following procedure will be used:

- Redirection
- Redirection with a 3 count

Rewards: Verbal praise, physical praise, stamps, stickers, notes home, individual and class rewards.

- A preschool staff member in charge of a child or a group of children shall be responsible for their discipline.
- Constructive, developmentally appropriate child guidance and management techniques are to be used at all times and shall include such measures as redirection, separation from problem situations, talking with the child about the situation and praise for appropriate behavior.
- Behavior management/discipline policies and procedures shall ensure the safety, physical and emotional well-being of all individuals on the premises.
- The center's actual methods of discipline shall apply to all persons on the premises and shall be restricted as follows:
 - There shall be no cruel, harsh, corporal punishment or any unusual punishments such as, but not limited to, punching, pinching, shaking, and spanking or biting.
 - No discipline shall be delegated to any other child.
 - No physical restraints shall be used to confine a child by any means other than holding a child for a short period of time, such as in a protective hug, so the child may regain control.
 - No child shall be placed in a locked room or confined in an unenclosed area such as a closet, a box or a similar cubicle.
 - No child shall be subjected to profane language, threats, derogatory remarks about the child or the child's family or other verbal abuse.
 - Discipline shall not be imposed on a child for failure to eat, failure to sleep or for toileting accidents.
 - Techniques of discipline shall not humiliate shame or frighten a child.
 - Discipline shall not include withholding food, rest or toilet use.
 - Separation, when used as discipline shall be brief in duration and appropriate to the child's age and developmental ability and the child

shall be within sight and hearing of a preschool staff member in a safe, lighted and well-ventilated space.

- The center shall not abuse or neglect children and shall protect children from abuse and neglect while in attendance in the preschool program.

STOPIT REPORTING HOTLINE: (440) 381 - 8983

The district has a service in which parents, students, and other community members can anonymously report anything that causes them concern regarding the safety or security of the students or schools. All should feel free to discuss concerns at any time with principals. However, if you'd feel more comfortable reporting a concern anonymously, please do not hesitate. A good rule of thumb: If it pops in your mind that maybe you should call the hotline with some information—then you should! This service is to keep all our kids' safe and secure at all times.